

community that wants and actively contributes to making a product richer and more stable. This model has proved to be far more effective than the closed proprietary software development model. Ingres works closely with its community to ensure they can take advantage of the product's core business critical capabilities but at the same time add their own contributions, and freely use all of this within the community versions.

For those customers that want our support services, we maintain a tightly managed enterprise version whereby we are able to ensure the quality and security of the software used to support their business operations. We charge for these services, sufficient to sustain robust business and provide a return to our shareholders. Ultimately, we are guided by the market as our customers will only pay for the services if they receive sufficient value. Otherwise they could move to the community version. Ultimately, we know we have a model that the market wants because we see them moving from more expensive proprietary offerings.

Q What drives the revenues for Ingres—the direct customers, systems integrators or Independent Software Vendors (ISVs)?

We at Ingres believe in providing key functions of technology that offer great value for money. We do sell directly to customers, but the fastest growing part of our revenue comes from the systems integrators (SIs) and ISVs.

Q Whom would you consider an Independent Software Vendor under your ISV programme?

In Ingres, we see three major groups of ISVs:

- Embedded: These ISVs tightly embed Ingres technology in their solutions and provide a complete support offering to their customers. We support the ISV directly in this case.
- Certified: These ISVs clearly see a demand in their market, which they address by offering their applications on several RDBMS platforms of which OSS is a growing element. We work with these ISVs to ensure our software works well together and customers can choose to purchase Ingres support from the ISV or directly from Ingres.
- Cloud/SAAS: The rapidly growing market for ISVs to offer their applications on a cloud/SAAS basis is a very exciting business for Ingres as our business model of subscriptions is completely aligned with the economics of the cloud/SAAS players.

Q Are you focusing only on the database space or do you also plan to go into the enterprise application stack?

Ingres' core focus is Enterprise Data Management – and offerings in this space are used by application vendors and end customers. There are very few RDBMS options left to the ISV community as application players have acquired the

RDBMS players. This is a great opportunity for Ingres to expand into this uncrowded space.

Q Do your consultants/partners recommend a customer only on the database front or would they also make recommendations for the OS, applications, virtualisation, hardware, back-up, network, etc?

Most buyers today look beyond just a single layer of technology when making purchasing decisions. Our systems integrator partners recognise this and have expanded their expertise to cover most areas of infrastructure. Our close partnerships with Red Hat, Novell, Talend, etc, ensure our customers and partners are not left to put the pieces together alone, as we do the integration/certification work in advance.

Q Do you involve community members in order to support and share their feedback on your open source products?

The community plays an important role for Ingres and we believe in learning and in educating others to spread the word. The best example is the MoU signed with the Ministry of Information and Telecommunication, Jordan, to set up an academic centre, also extended to universities, to train professionals in the Middle East. We also receive good contributions from the community, which we include in our product. Some good examples of such community contributions include Ingres CAFÉ (for Eclipse-based development and the winner of *LinuxWorld's* 'Best application development tool' award), EasyIngres (for PHP-based development), Ingres Migration Toolset (for migrating to Ingres from other databases—available on Sourceforge) and the Ingres Geospatial Project.

Q We have been hearing some exciting news about your new launch—VectorWise? Can you shed some light on it?

Ingres VectorWise is a revolutionary analytical database technology, which is an innovation in the database world. It leverages the computing power of the modern micro processors, making 'Analytics at the speed of Thought', a reality. Customers and partners who are already using Ingres VectorWise are seeing query performance gains of 10-70 times on a single server, vis-à-vis other leading databases, when analysing massive data volumes running into millions and billions of rows. Ingres VectorWise not only provides these dramatic performance gains but also lowers TCO significantly, as it is a simple single commodity server solution eliminating the need for massive configurations of database servers or MPP solutions which are very expensive and complex to deploy and run. Ingres VectorWise is also very simple to run with no need for indexing, self-tuning, etc, which again results in savings on the specialist DBA skills required with other solutions.